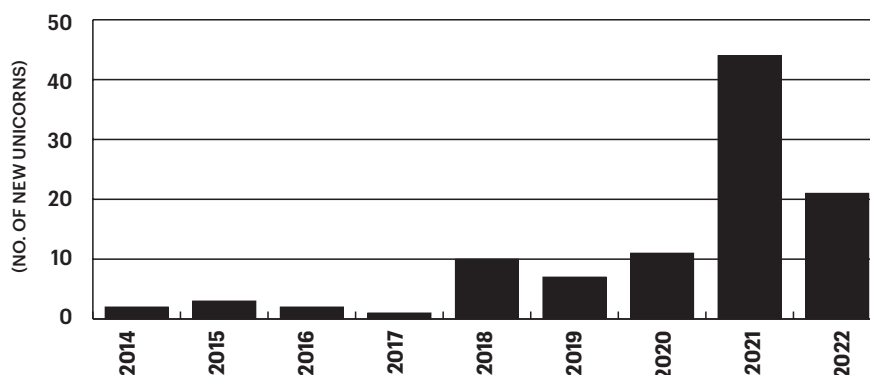


UNICORN METER

The number of unicorns created in India reached a peak in 2021, but the numbers fell in 2022



SOURCE INVEST INDIA

WINNING GAME

VC investments in India hit a high in 2021 before declining slightly in 2022

NOTE 1. VC INCLUDES: I) SEED TO SERIES F INVESTMENTS IN COMPANIES LESS THAN 10 YEARS OLD; AND II) LATE-STAGE TECH INVESTMENTS
2. DATA EXCLUDES POST-2018 INVESTMENTS INTO FLIPKART

SOURCE VENTURE INTELLIGENCE

Period	No. of deals	Amount (\$ million)	Avg. ticket size (\$ million)
2018	755	10,726	14
2019	905	13,407	15
2020	824	11,522	14
2021	1,215	35,461	29
2022	1,130	23,957	21

work and Open Network for Digital Commerce could provide unprecedented opportunities to advance digital financial inclusion for the next half-billion (first-time internet users) and micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) over the next decades,” says Treasa Mathew, Director, Investments at Omidyar Network India.

A growing number of start-ups are now offering specialised digital financial services to under-banked and unbanked segments of society, such as MSMEs, agricultural sectors, women-focussed financial services, and low-income households. The sachet model in financial services is picking up where fintech start-ups are offering small-ticket

loans to consumers.

“Digital financial inclusion start-ups have the potential to increase access to financial services for under-banked and unbanked populations, which can drive economic growth and development. Over the next 25 years, successfully driving financial inclusion for individuals and businesses at the last mile will be key to the economy’s overall success,” says Hardika Shah, Founder and CEO of MSME lending firm Kinara Capital.

Puneet Agarwal, CEO of fintech start-up Money View, says the gap in access to financial services for underserved customers will be reduced with data, AI, technology, and product innovations over the next few years.

THE EDTECH CONUNDRUM

Perhaps the most discussed and criticised start-up segment in the past year, edtech faced heavy headwinds as the pandemic-induced digital boom began to wind down. However, founders and investors say the potential to create a significant impact and establish thriving enterprises in this field is just starting to take shape.

Making a rough estimate of the edtech opportunity in India, Mohan Lakhmaraju, Founder and CEO of Great Learning (acquired by BYJU’S), says “Education today in India is about \$30 billion in size. In 25 years, even if you assume the country grows only at 5 per cent per annum, it’s going to be \$80 billion.